

film review Sugar 'n' Spice

CHEENI KUM

Starring: Amitabh Bachchan, Tabu, Paresh Rawal

Directed by: R. Balakrishnan

Thirteen years ago, while scripting *Dilwale Dulhania Le Jayenge*, Aditya Chopra wrote a scene in which Raj would walk into a store to buy a condom. Later, he decided that this might be too risqué for the audiences and changed it to beer. Obviously, times and audiences have changed. In *Cheeni Kum*, Amitabh Bachchan walks into a store and sheepishly asks for a condom to which the salesman snidely remarks: *chacha ko Durex chahiye*.

Cheeni Kum brims with



Bachchan and Tabu

quirky, funny moments like this. Debutant director R. Balakrishnan builds up a spicy, affectionate romance between an attractive, intelligent woman and a bristling, sarcastic chef who happens to be 30 years her senior—actually he's six years older than her father. Tabu and Bachchan hit all the right

notes. But post-interval, the script and their romance collapse like an underdone soufflé. The girl's father (Rawal in a woefully underwritten role), goes on a fast to prevent her from marrying and the ensuing melodrama deflates the film. Still, this one's worth watching if only to see the still sexy Mr B in heat. **by Anupama Chopra**

music review Alchemy of Sounds



Sa Re Ga Ma
Rs 295

URBAN RAGA

In this album of a live recording, Abhijit

Pohankar plays Hindustani

classical music on the keyboard and succeeds in giving the traditional compositions a twist. Remember Piya Bawari and Sajamwa. Earlier, he called it the new-age raga and now the Urban Raga. A modern interpretation of traditional melodies, this album features his father, Pandit Ajay Pohankar too. He explores the alchemy between traditional Indian music and contemporary sounds, textures and music arrangement. The result of using a combination of modern instruments like the guitar and keyboard and traditional ones like the flute is a stunning tapestry of sounds. "I hope people will now connect with what I wanted to convey in my earlier albums in terms of the uniqueness of my approach. I have brought traditional compositions of Indian classical music to the uninitiated listener who always shied away from it," says Pohankar junior. The highlight of the album is Pohankar's rendition of Begum Akhtar's immortal ghazal *Ae mohabbat tere anjam pe rona aaya*. The interludes on the keyboard are beyond imagination and add a new dimension to the song. Yet another piece of powerful rendition is *Yaad piya ki aye*. A class apart.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

Works by Datta (far left) and Krishan Khanna

MUMBAI Even as Gallery Chemould prepares to vacate the Jehangir Art Gallery, it will give art lovers an opportunity to access its illustrious archives. As a "parting show," the Gandhi family has opened up its stockroom to art aficionados in an exhibition called All Stock Must Go. "We have collected several works over 40 years that have caught our eye but haven't been on display due to lack of space," says gallery director Shireen Gandhi. Up for grabs are paintings, prints and watercolours by Vishwanadhan, Jeram Patel, Krishan Khanna and others. The prices are affordable for "budget art shoppers" starting at Rs 2,000. From June 8-30.

by Kimi Dangor



packet that takes the form of an apparition. "Instead of defining the domain, Pradip liberates space and offers supplementarity to elements of seeing," says author and film scholar Sanjay Mukhopadhyay. Almost everyone who has seen his works will corroborate the statement. To see for yourself, visit Gorky Sadan from June 4-8. **by Swagata Sen**

recommendations Flight of Fancy

KOLKATA It's all about how you see things. And Pradip Datta sees them differently. His forthcoming exhibition at Gorky Sadan has some amazing photographs that challenge your imagination and perception—a mass of hair that takes on a human shape, a tree's branches taking the shape of a woman's curves, and even a soaked plastic

